GRACE AWAKA OTSIMI

Creative, Brand & Digital Communications Professional
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Creative, Brand and Digital Communications Professional with 6+ years of FMCG experience across East and Sub-Saharan Africa, spanning brand development, packaging, product launches, digital communication, social media, trade assets and corporate communication. Proven ability to translate business goals into consumer-facing campaigns and brand systems, manage agencies and cross-functional stakeholders, and deliver result-led work across Amara, Miadi, SoSoft, ACE, Ashanti-Q and the HACO corporate brand. Known for digital campaign execution, including the Amara OUD launch with 2.5M+ views, website revamp delivery with 22,000+ visits in 30 days, and brand page growth across multiple categories.

SELECTED IMPACT

- **22,000+ website visits** delivered within 30 days after leading the HACO website revamp from ideation to launch execution.
- **2.5M+ views** achieved through digital execution of the Amara OUD launch, strengthening visibility across digital platforms.
- **ACE digital growth from 1,500 to 29,000+ followers**, contributing to 98% digital uptake against budget for ACE Extension products.
- **5 brand-owned pages managed**, increasing audience engagement by 33% through consistent publishing, optimization and community management.
- **40% average engagement growth** across brand social media pages using content planning, audience insights and performance optimization.
- **30+ creative, packaging and communication projects delivered annually** across marketing, sales, regulatory, procurement, suppliers and agencies.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Brand & Campaigns:** Brand strategy execution; creative direction; campaign development; product launch support; brand identity governance; trade and corporate communication.
- **Digital & Content:** Social media management; digital channel management; community engagement; content storytelling; campaign performance monitoring; Meta Insights, Google Analytics and Search Console.
- **Packaging & Delivery:** Packaging design; product development support; agency management; creative quality control; stakeholder coordination; brand asset management; cross-functional project delivery.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Brand & Communications Designer | **HACO Industries Kenya Ltd** | *Nairobi, Kenya* | *Jan 2020 - Present*
Portfolio: Amara, Miadi, SoSoft, ACE, Ashanti-Q and HACO corporate brand across digital, print, packaging, trade, internal and corporate communication channels.

- Managed digital communication and content execution across **5 brand-owned pages**, increasing audience engagement by **33%** and improving campaign visibility through consistent publishing, platform optimization and community management.

- Led end-to-end digital content planning for integrated campaigns across Amara, Miadi, SoSoft, ACE and Ashanti-Q, contributing to **3M+ campaign reach** and **70% engagement growth** across digital platforms.
- Managed the Managing Director's social media presence through structured content planning and brand-aligned communication, supporting **65% growth in followers/impressions** and **75% engagement growth** across posts.
- Coordinated external creative and digital agencies across **5 campaigns annually**, reducing revision cycles by **80%** through clearer briefs, quality control and stakeholder alignment.
- Monitored audience behavior, campaign performance and digital trends using Meta Insights, Google Analytics and Search Console, improving content relevance and increasing engagement rates by **40%** through data-informed optimization.
- Managed brand consistency across HACO's portfolio, ensuring alignment across packaging, digital, print, trade and corporate communication touchpoints.
- Developed and maintained visual identity systems and brand guidelines for **5 brands**, improving consistency across campaigns and reducing brand deviations during execution.
- Translated brand strategy into consumer-facing creative outputs that strengthened product differentiation, shelf visibility and launch readiness for ACE Bleach, SoSoft Sachets, Amara Shower Gel Vitamin N and Amara Handwash Revamp.
- Partnering with marketing, product development, sales, procurement and regulatory teams to deliver **30+ brand assets annually** with commercial relevance, compliance and timely execution.
- Delivered creative assets across print, digital, social media, e-commerce, trade and internal communication channels for **5 campaigns annually**, supporting awareness, engagement and sales objectives including Jumia visibility.
- Developed campaign visual systems, launch communication materials and seasonal promotional assets, including Amara OUD Body Lotions, contributing to **60% growth** in engagement, reach and campaign performance.
- Led packaging design and renovation projects across **5 FMCG SKUs/categories** in homecare, skincare and haircare, improving shelf visibility, communication clarity and brand consistency.
- Created packaging concepts, label systems, mockups and prototypes for launches including the Amara Shower Gel mould-shape bottle design, accelerating approvals and supporting production readiness.
- Designed corporate materials including HACO Catalogue, HACO Hotel Catalogue, TUKIO newsletters, board presentations, brochures and internal assets, improving communication consistency and stakeholder engagement.
- Coordinated **30+ creative, packaging, digital and communication projects annually** while maintaining **80% on-time delivery** and compliance with brand, regulatory and production requirements.

Graphic Design Intern | **HACO Industries Kenya Ltd** | *Nairobi, Kenya* | *Mar 2018 - Dec 2019*

- Supported development of social media content, marketing materials, print layouts and visual communication assets for brand and campaign needs.
- Assisted with image editing, layout adjustments, file preparation, visual consistency checks and creative asset organization, improving design workflow efficiency.
- Supported project coordination by gathering requirements, conducting research and preparing creative files for internal and external stakeholders.

Cyber Attendant | **Local Cyber** | *Nairobi, Kenya* | *Apr 2019 - Dec 2019*

- Provided customer support, basic technical assistance, document preparation and digital literacy support while maintaining workstation operations and usage compliance.

SELECTED BRAND & CAMPAIGN PROJECTS

Amara Sunscreen Launch | 2026: Led packaging identity and communication assets for Amara's entry into the sunscreen category, supporting brand consistency, shelf appeal and category communication clarity.

Ghana Market Entry Communication Support | 2026: Developed and localized communication materials for the Ghana market, balancing cultural relevance with core brand identity across digital and print adaptations.

Amara Antibacterial Handwash Revamp | 2026: Led the visual refresh of the range, improving variant consistency, communication clarity and product appeal through concept development, stakeholder review and supplier alignment.

ACE Bleach Packaging Redesign | 2025: Directed packaging redesign and rollout across multiple SKUs, strengthening shelf visibility, variant communication and brand recognition while managing feedback and regulatory requirements.

MIADI Sheen Spray, Moulding Gel & Firm Hold Styling Gel Packaging | 2025: Led packaging design and visual direction across three Miadi styling products, strengthening portfolio consistency and shelf appeal.

Amara Deodorant & Antiperspirant Launch: Managed creative development from concept to commercialization, translating product positioning into packaging direction and launch communication materials.

ACE Disinfectants Launch: Supported category expansion through packaging development and communication assets
aligned with brand objectives, consumer needs and market expectations.

Amara Shower Gel First Launch: Developed foundational visual identity and packaging direction, supporting product introduction through packaging design and launch communication materials.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Diploma in Digital Marketing
Zetech University Jan 2026 - Present

Certificate in Digital Marketing
Zetech University May 2025 - Dec 2025

Digital Marketing Masterclass Certificate
Strathmore Business School Feb 2025

Diploma in Graphic Design
Nairobits School of Digital Design and ICT Jan 2018 - Jun 2019

Certificate in Internet Research
Nairobits School of Digital Design and ICT Jan 2017 - Dec 2017

Certificate in Graphic Design | Nairobits School of Digital Design Jan 2016 - Jul 2016

Professional Certifications: Fundamentals of Digital Marketing, Google; Meta Blueprint.

Tools

Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, After Effects, Premiere Pro, Lightroom; Canva; CapCut; Meta Business Suite; Meta Ads Manager; Google Analytics; Google Business Profile; Search Console; Microsoft Office; Google Workspace; Trello; Notion.

References: Available on request.